ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** Robert Arthur	Robert Arthur wrote it.
2	**(a)** he jumped out of the window expecting a balcony	He believed the lie and leapt.
3	**(b)** reckless	Reckless.
4	**(a)** Fowler	Fowler, the young writer, tells it.
5	**(d)** quick wit and calm under danger	He outwits the armed visitor with a clever lie.
6	**(a)** a person running away	One who flees.
7	**(a)** writer of spy stories	He wanted to write detective and spy fiction.
8	**(a)** midnight	The title suggests a midnight visit.
9	**(d)** wit can defeat force	Ausable defeats an armed man by wit.
10	**(d)** secret agent	He worked as a secret agent.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Fowler is a young man who narrates the story (1) and who wants to become a writer of detective and spy stories (1).	1+1
12	He said there was a balcony below the window (1) that could be reached from a vacant room, so Max jumped to flee (1).	1+1
13	Ausable acted calmly and casually (1) so he seemed to be in no danger though Max held a gun (1).	1+1
14	He wanted to meet a real secret agent (1) and hoped to learn material for his stories (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Ausable was a plump, quiet man with a plain face. He did not look at all like the dashing spy of stories. Fowler was surprised and a little disappointed.	1+1+1
16	He is the narrator and the audience. We see the events through his young eyes. His surprise and learning guide the reader.	1+1+1
17	He felt astonished and admiring. He realised that his own picture of spies was childish. He learned that real adventure needs a clever mind.	1+1+1
	OR: Fowler imagined a mysterious man in dark clothes living a life of danger. He saw instead a calm, ordinary-looking agent who used wit. His idea of spying became more realistic.	1+1+1
18	The visit of Max at midnight is the central event. It brings danger and the climax. The title adds mystery and suspense.	1+1+1
	OR: Max broke into the room and demanded the papers. Both verbs are in simple past tense.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Ausable is a plump, calm secret agent (1). He does not look heroic (1). He is clever and quick-witted (1). He outwits Max with a false balcony (1). He shows courage under pressure (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Suspense begins at the unexpected knock (1). Max's armed entry raises danger (1). Ausable's calm creates doubt (1). The knock at the door builds tension (1). The jump resolves it (1).	2+2+1
20	Fowler is a young man who dreams of writing spy stories (1). He admires adventure (1). He is surprised by Ausable's appearance (1). He learns from the event (1). He narrates the story (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Date (1). First impression of Ausable (1). Max's intrusion (1). The trick and the jump (1). Reflection on spies and stories (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Ausable a tall, handsome secret agent; he is a **fat, ordinary-looking** man, unlike the spies Fowler imagined from books.

- Writing that the visitor Max came through the front door; he is a spy who enters the room **unseen at midnight**, and holds Ausable and Fowler at gunpoint.
- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.
- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.
- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
- Spelling slips: *Ausable, Fowler, espionage, balcony, thriller*; and mixed tenses when summarising the plot.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** a dashing, mysterious figure	He had a romantic image from fiction.
2	**(b)** real spying is a matter of cleverness, not show	Insight into real intelligence work.
3	**(a)** a hotel room in Paris	Ausable's room in a Paris hotel.
4	**(d)** tense and suspenseful	A thriller.
5	**(b)** make Max panic	It added to Max's fear.
6	**(b)** an armed rival agent who broke into the room	Max came to steal secret papers.
7	**(d)** Max leaps from the window	The decisive moment.
8	**(a)** danger and suspense	Suspense.
9	**(c)** secret papers	The papers were valuable to a foreign power.
10	**(a)** a competitor	A rival competes.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	He thought the police were coming (1) and rushed to escape by the window (1).	1+1
12	Ausable stays calm facing an armed man (1) and uses intelligence rather than force (1).	1+1
13	He expected a thrilling, mysterious figure (1) but Ausable was a plain, heavy and cheerful man (1).	1+1
14	He believed the balcony existed (1) and wished to escape before he was arrested (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Max entered armed and demanded the papers. He was cold and threatening and held Ausable and Fowler under his control. His arrival turned a pleasant talk into a tense scene.	1+1+1
16	Short, sharp conversation and the threat of a gun keep the reader on edge. Silence and knocks add to the suspense. The release of tension comes only with the jump.	1+1+1
17	Ausable told Fowler that he was a secret agent. 'Said to' becomes 'told'; 'I am' becomes 'he was'.	1+1+1
	OR: He spoke easily to Max, as if no threat existed. He gave nothing away by his face. His calm helped him invent a plan quickly.	1+1+1
18	Intelligence and calm thinking can defeat strength and weapons. A clever plan saves life without fighting. We should not panic in danger.	1+1+1
	OR: Max was Ausable's rival. The papers were a secret. The story is full of suspense.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Max enters armed and demands the papers (1). Ausable remains calm (1). He invents a balcony (1). A knock frightens Max (1). Max jumps out (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Ausable looked ordinary (1). He proved a sharp agent (1). Fowler misjudged him (1). Appearance can hide ability (1). We must look at action and mind (1).	2+2+1
20	Fowler visits Ausable in Paris (1). Ausable is unlike a spy (1). Max breaks in for the papers (1). Ausable tricks him with a balcony lie (1). Max jumps and the danger ends (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Place and time (1). Details of the intruder (1). Account of the fall (1). Statements from witnesses (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Calling Ausable a tall, handsome secret agent; he is a **fat, ordinary-looking** man, unlike the spies Fowler imagined from books.
- Writing that the visitor Max came through the front door; he is a spy who enters the room **unseen at midnight**, and holds Ausable and Fowler at gunpoint.
- Mixing up the trick: Ausable bluffs that police are at the door, and Max jumps through the window to a 'balcony' that **does not exist**.
- Calling Fowler the hero; he is a young writer of *romantic spy tales* who learns that real adventure is different.

- Forgetting that the 'police' were only a **waiter** with a drink, which Ausable had expected from **Henry**.
- Spelling slips: *Ausable, Fowler, espionage, balcony, thriller*; and mixed tenses when summarising the plot.

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ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 12: **The Midnight Visitor (Footprints Without Feet)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(c)** one who enters without permission	Intruder = unwelcome entrant.
2	**(a)** plump and unlike a daring spy	Fowler was disappointed by his ordinary appearance.
3	**(d)** The room was entered by Max.	Past simple passive.
4	**(c)** heavy-set with a plain face	He did not look heroic.
5	**(c)** that a balcony lay outside the window	He invented a balcony to save himself.
6	**(d)** balcony	The balcony was imaginary.
7	**(a)** Max ordered him to give him the papers.	Imperative becomes 'ordered ... to'.
8	**(d)** the sixth	It was high above the street.
9	**(b)** simple past	Pointed is simple past.
10	**(c)** slow, tense dialogue and delayed revelation	Reveal comes late.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Wit and presence of mind can defeat brute force (1) and appearances can be deceptive (1).	1+1
12	Max was a rival agent working for another power (1) who forced his way in to seize Ausable's secret papers (1).	1+1
13	Ausable had no balcony and had tricked Max (1) so a sharp mind is a spy's best weapon (1).	1+1
14	He delays the solution until the last moment (1) and uses tense dialogue and sudden turns (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	He told Max that a balcony lay under the window, reached from a nearby room. When a knock came, Max believed the police were at the door and leapt for the balcony. There was no balcony, so he fell.	1+1+1
16	The story takes place in a Paris hotel room on a high floor, at night. The closed, high room makes escape difficult and adds to the tension.	1+1+1
17	Calmness, quick thinking, cleverness and courage. A good agent plans and does not fight openly. Appearance does not matter.	1+1+1
	OR: Ausable looks dull and heavy but is sharp and brave. Fowler judged him by his looks and was wrong. The story warns us not to judge people by outward show.	1+1+1
18	Max had a gun and Ausable could not overpower him. A story about a balcony needed only words. It saved Ausable's papers and his life.	1+1+1
	OR: The ending is sudden and surprising. Max jumps and the reader learns the trick. The calm humour of Ausable lightens the final tension.	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Max has a gun and strength (1). Ausable has only words (1). A false balcony makes Max panic (1). Max defeats himself (1). Wit wins (1).	2+2+1
	OR: A hotel room on a high floor (1). The closed space limits escape (1). The window plays a key role (1). Night adds mystery (1). The setting supports the trick (1).	2+2+1
20	Define presence of mind (1). Example of Ausable (1). Value in emergencies (1). Examples from daily life (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Correct format (1). Max demands the papers (1). Ausable stalls calmly (1). A hint of the balcony (1). Rising tension (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

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